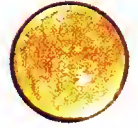
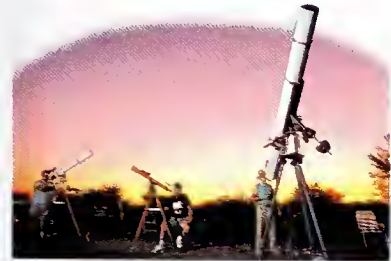


Sun and stars

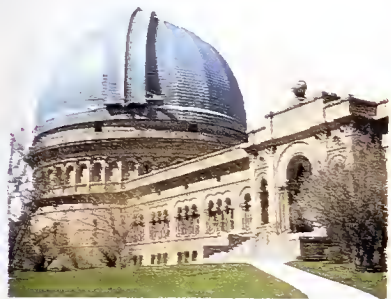


Studying stars

Astronomers use different instruments to view the stars.



Telescopes offer the simplest way to look at the stars.



Observatories contain huge telescopes that can see many miles into space.



Space satellites send back pictures of stars to the Earth.

Huge groups of stars in space are called galaxies. The galaxy we live in is called the Milky Way. Our Sun is just one of millions of stars in the Milky Way.

Sun

Like all stars, the Sun is a huge ball of super-hot gas. It burns very brightly, giving Earth the heat and light it needs to support life.

Dark patches are called sunspots.



Eclipse

When the Moon passes in front of the Sun, it blocks out most of its light. This is called an eclipse.

Did you know?

It would take about 20 years for a jumbo jet to travel from Earth to the Sun!



Solar-powered car

Solar power

The Sun's rays can be used to make electricity.

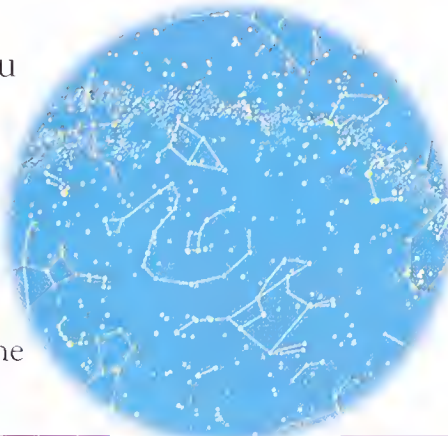
The hottest part of the Sun is its center. This is called the core.

The Sun's rays are so powerful they can damage the human eye.

Mapping stars

On a clear night you can see thousands of stars in the sky. Astronomers have made maps of the stars.

Star map of the northern skies



Constellations

Groups of stars are called constellations. Each group is given a name.



Libra



Taurus



Sagittarius

